

Ideation Phase

Define the Problem Statements

Date	3July2026
Project Name	Smart Library Request Workflow using ServiceNow

Customer Problem Statement

Academic libraries currently face significant challenges in managing book requests and inventory due to manual processes. Students struggle to find available books and wait for responses on their borrow requests because librarians manage requests through paper forms, emails, or spreadsheets without a centralized tracking system. Librarians spend excessive time manually updating book status, processing requests, and generating reports instead of focusing on student support and resource development. This results in delays, lost requests, inaccurate inventory data, and poor visibility into borrowing patterns. Additionally, students have no clear view of their request status or expected turnaround time, leading to frustration and reduced library engagement.

To address these challenges, a digital Smart Library Request Workflow is required. The system should streamline borrow request submission, automate librarian approvals, track real-time book status, provide students with immediate visibility into their requests, enable librarians to manage inventory efficiently, and generate insights into borrowing trends. By automating the entire request lifecycle, the library can improve operational efficiency, reduce errors, enhance user experience, and make data-driven decisions for resource allocation.

PS	I am (Customer)	I'm trying to	But	Because	Which makes me feel
PS-1	Student	Find request and an available book quickly	I have to contact the librarian via email or in person and wait days for a response	There is no online catalog or self-service request system	Frustrated and discouraged from using the library
PS-2	Student	Track status of borrow request the my	I don't know if my request was received, approved, or when the book will be ready	The librarian has no system to provide status updates, and I receive no notification	Anxious and uncertain about the process
PS-3	Librarian	Manage process and borrow requests	Requests arrive via email, phone, or paper forms without a	There is no centralized system to track,	Overwhelmed and unable to meet student demands

		efficiently	structured workflow	prioritize, or automate request processing	
PS-4	Librarian	Keep accurate and real-time records of book availability	Book status is manually updated in spreadsheets and often inconsistent	When a request is approved, the status is not automatically updated	Concerned about inventory accuracy and student experience
PS-5	Librarian	Understand borrowing patterns and make data-driven decisions	Generating reports from manual records is time-consuming and error-prone	There is no system to track borrowing trends or create automated reports	Unable to optimize resource allocation and budget planning
PS-6	Library Manager	Monitor library operations and ensure quality service	I have no visibility into request processing times, approval rates, or bottlenecks	There are no dashboards or reports to track key performance metrics	Powerless to improve processes or hold teams accountable

Key Problems Identified

- No centralized online system for students to browse and request books
- Manual request handling leads to delays and lost requests
- Book status is not updated in real-time, causing inventory inaccuracies
- Students have no visibility into request status or turnaround time
- Librarians spend excessive time on administrative tasks instead of student support
- No automated workflow to streamline approval and fulfillment
- Lack of reporting and analytics to understand borrowing trends
- No tool to monitor service performance or identify bottlenecks